

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

----- X

DEMETRUES BELL,

Plaintiff,

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK; POLICE OFFICER
CHRISTOPHER MEDINA; POLICE OFFICER JUAN
CANDELARIO; POLICE OFFICER YAHKEEM WHITE;
POLICE OFFICER MICHAEL PANDO; SERGEANT
MICHAEL BLETCHER,

Defendants.

SUMMONS

Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of IncidentPlaintiff designates Bronx
County as the place of trial.

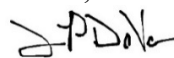
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To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
October 4, 2020

Yours, etc.

DEVERNA LAW
John Paul DeVerna, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff(s)
111 John Street, Suite 1615
New York, New York 10038
T- (212) 321-0025
F- (212) 321-0024

Defendants' Addresses:

CITY OF NEW YORK; Corporation Counsel; 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

CHRISTOPHER MEDINA; PSA-7; 737 Melrose Ave, Bronx, NY 10455

JUAN CANDELARIO; PSA-7; 737 Melrose Ave, Bronx, NY 10455

YAHKEEM WHITE; PSA-7; 737 Melrose Ave, Bronx, NY 10455

MICHAEL PANDO; PSA-7; 737 Melrose Ave, Bronx, NY 10455

MICHAEL BLETCHER; PSA-7; 737 Melrose Ave, Bronx, NY 10455

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

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DEMETRUES BELL,

Plaintiff,

-against-

INDEX NO.:

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

CITY OF NEW YORK; POLICE OFFICER
CHRISTOPHER MEDINA; POLICE OFFICER JUAN
CANDELARIO; POLICE OFFICER YAHKEEM WHITE;
POLICE OFFICER MICHAEL PANDO; SERGEANT
MICHAEL BLETCHER,

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

Defendants.

----- X

Plaintiff DEMETRUES BELL, by his attorneys, DEVERNA LAW, as and for his Verified
Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York.
2. On or about June 28, 2019, at approximately 3:55PM, Plaintiff DEMETRUES BELL, while lawfully in the vicinity of 575 EAST 137th Street, Bronx, NY, was subject to illegal search, false arrest, false imprisonment, malicious prosecution by Defendants. As a direct and proximate cause, Plaintiff was unlawfully detained within the New York City Police Department within the jurisdictional confines of Bronx County, New York. Plaintiff was deprived of his liberty for approximately two hundred-ten (210) days and suffered serious

and emotional injuries. He was maliciously prosecuted, until the criminal matter against him was dismissed.

3. Plaintiff in furtherance of their cause of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK within ninety (90) days of the accrual dates for these claims, in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.
4. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claims or otherwise resolved them.
5. This action and all associated claims have been timely brought within the applicable statutes of limitations.
6. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.
7. Plaintiff seeks monetary damages (compensatory and punitive) against Defendants, as well as an award of cost and attorneys' fees, and such other relief as the Court may deem just and proper.

PARTIES

8. Plaintiff DEMETRUES BELL is a resident of the state of New York.
9. The Defendant City of New York ("City") is a municipal corporation organized under the laws of the State of New York.
10. At all times relevant hereto, Defendant City, acting through the NYPD, was responsible for the policy, practice, supervision, implementation, and conduct of all NYPD matters and was responsible for the appointment, training, supervision, discipline and retention and

conduct of all NYPD personnel, including police officers, detectives and supervisory officers as well as the individually named Defendants herein.

11. In addition, at all times here relevant, Defendant City was responsible for enforcing the rules of the NYPD, and for ensuring that the NYPD personnel obey the laws of the United States and the State of New York.
12. Defendant CHRISTOPHER MEDINA, was, at all times here relevant, a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant Medina is sued in his individual and official capacity.
13. Defendant JUAN CANDELARIO, was, at all times here relevant, a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant Candelario is sued in his individual and official capacity.
14. Defendant YAHKEEM WHITE, was, at all times here relevant, a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant White is sued in his individual and official capacity.
15. Defendant MICHAEL PANDO, was, at all times here relevant, a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant Pando is sued in his individual and official capacity.
16. Defendant MICHAEL BLETCHER, was, at all times here relevant, a sergeant employed by the NYPD and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant Bletcher is sued in his individual and official capacity.

17. At all times here the mentioned Defendants were acting under color of state law, to wit, under color of the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies, customs and usages of the City and State of New York.
18. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.
19. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

FACTUAL CHARGES

20. On June 28, 2019, at approximately 3:55PM, Plaintiff was in the vicinity of 575 East 137th Street, Bronx County.
21. Plaintiff was lawfully present in his parked car with running engine and closed windows and otherwise did not appear to be violating any law or ordinance.
22. Defendants had no probable cause to pull over or otherwise approach Plaintiff's vehicle.
23. Despite having no legal basis, Defendants without probable cause ordered Plaintiff to step out from the car.
24. Defendants, acting in concert, searched Plaintiff's person and vehicle without his authority or permission.

25. Plaintiff was thereafter falsely arrested by Defendants under NYPD arrest number B19626778.
26. At no point did Plaintiff resist arrest.
27. Plaintiff had multiple assault and batteries committed to his person by Defendants including but not limited to being placed in handcuffs too tightly.
28. Based on information and belief, a Defendant supervisor, Defendant Bletcher was present on the scene and did not stop the unlawful arrest of Plaintiff.
29. Plaintiff was then taken to a local NYPD Precinct, and criminally processed and then transferred to Central Booking.
30. Defendants, acting with malice, conveyed false information to prosecutors.
31. Defendants prepared false sworn affidavits and false police reports relating to Plaintiff's arrest and provided false testimony.
32. Defendants repeatedly falsified information and testimony relating to the facts and circumstances surrounding Plaintiff's arrest.
33. At his criminal court arraignment, bail was set and Plaintiff was thereafter transferred to Rikers Island.
34. Plaintiff was maliciously prosecuted for said incident from the date of arraignment until his release.
35. The criminal case against the Plaintiff was later transferred to the United States District Court and prosecuted under Index number 19-CR-717.
36. On or about January 24, 2020, all charges against Plaintiff were favorably dismissed on after the Hon. Lewis A. Kaplan, after a thorough consideration found Defendant's had

violated Plaintiff's constitutional rights, including his right to be free from unlawful search and seizure.

37. On or about, January 24, 2020, after being in custody for approximately Two Hundred-Ten (210) Days, Plaintiff was released.
38. During all of the events described, Defendants acted maliciously, willfully, knowingly and with the specific intent to injure Plaintiff and violate his civil rights.
39. At all times relevant hereto, Defendants were involved in the decision to violate Plaintiff's civil rights, including falsely arresting Plaintiff, and failed to intervene in the actions of their fellow officers.
40. Several Defendants, who did not participate in the incident, but were otherwise present and observed the violation of Plaintiff's constitutional rights failed to intercede on Plaintiff's behalf.
41. At all times relevant hereto, Defendants were involved in the decision to arrest Plaintiff without probable cause or failed to intervene in the actions of his fellow officers when they observed them arresting Plaintiff without probable cause.
42. The City has been on notice for more than a generation that brutality is widespread and that particular reforms need to be implemented. From reform-minded Commissioner Patrick Murphy to the *Mollen* Commission twenty-five years later, the City has been repeatedly cautioned that a systemic tolerance for brutality flourishes throughout the NYPD. Indeed, years before said violation was perpetrated upon Plaintiff, the *Mollen* Commission report noted, "This tolerance, or willful blindness, extends to supervisors as well. This is because many supervisors share the perception that nothing is really wrong with a bit of unnecessary force and because they believe that this is the only way to fight crime today."

Mollen Comm. Report, at 49; The City of New York Commission to Combat Police Corruption, *passim*.

43. The individually named Defendants herein, as well as other officers serving in the employee of the NYPD, and the City of New York, have blatantly, shamelessly, consistently, and repeatedly engaged in conduct violative of the civil rights guaranteed and protected by the Constitution of the United States, in addition to the laws and Constitution of the State of New York, or without incurring any ramifications for such misconduct and, ostensibly, with the full and complete blessing of the NYPD, The City of New York and their respective policymakers and supervisors
44. The City of New York has a long-standing and ignominious record of failing to discipline its officers or even entertaining allegations of wrongdoing against them. On June 26, 2019, *The New York Times* published an article entitled *2495 Reports of Police Bias*. One was deemed valid by the NYPD worried that within the last five years almost 2,500 several individuals have filed formal complaint with the NYPD alleging that an officer acted with biased towards them, would not one single being substantiated by the NYPD such a finding is playing the incredible and obviously the result of a deliberately poor or non-existent investigatory protocol the report commitment to combat the prejudices and the bias is exhibited by many of his officers.
45. Upon information and belief, the City of New York, and their respective policymakers, officials or supervisors have approved or acquiesced to policies, customs, or patterns and practices within the City that resulted in Plaintiff's arrest without probable cause

46. Upon information and belief, the city of New York, and their respective policymakers or supervisors have failed to provide adequate training regarding the identification of probable cause, reason suspicion or the appropriate amount of force to be used.
47. Defendant's actions, pursuant to plaintiff's underlying arrest, which occurred without even the semblance of probable cause, were so blatantly violative of plaintiff's civil rights that the tacit approval by the policymakers or supervisors of the City of New York, as well as their deliberate indifference towards the right of any individuals who may come into contact with defendants, should be inferred, because such makers deprivations of constitutionally protected rights could not and would not occur without the tacit approval or deliberate indifference regarding the commission of such violations by the policymakers were supervisors of the city of New York.
48. Upon information and belief further details and facts relating to the unlawful policies customs or patterns and practices of the City of New York and their respective policymakers supervisors police officers or employees, will become known after the completion of Discovery, as such information is presently within the exclusive possession of defendants, and the City of New York
49. Upon information and belief, the personal files, records and disciplinary histories of the officers Defendants will reveal a history of constitutional violations indicative of Defendant City's, knowledge that the individual officer Defendants were unfit for employment as peace officers, or poor employment in general, and that the probability of the individually named defendant committed similar violations in the future was extremely high.

50. Upon information and belief said personnel files records and disciplinary histories will conclusively show that the city was fully aware of Defendant's past constitutional violations, unacceptably high probability for the reoccurrence of similar transgressions, the unreasonably dangerous situations that were likely to result from their hiring or retention, as well as their unsuitability for employment as Law Enforcement Officers, or for employment in general, and did not engage in any preventative or corrective action in the likelihood of recurrence for such violations, which is tantamount to the city of tacit approval of such misconduct or the city's deliberate indifference towards civil rights of those who may interact with employees including Plaintiff
51. As a direct and proximate result of the acts of Defendants, Plaintiff suffered the following injuries and damages: violation of his rights pursuant to the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments of the United States Constitution, physical injury, physical pain and suffering, economic loss, loss of property, emotional trauma and suffering, including fear, embarrassment, humiliation, emotional distress, frustration, extreme inconvenience, anxiety, loss of liberty and harm to reputation.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Stop and Search Under
New York State Law

52. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
53. Defendants violated Common Law, the Laws of the State of New York and the New York Constitution because they stopped and searched Plaintiff without reasonable suspicion.
54. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

55. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.
56. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Stop and Search
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

57. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
58. Defendants violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments because they stopped and searched Plaintiff without reasonable suspicion.
59. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
60. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.
61. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment Under
New York State Law

62. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
63. Defendants subjected Plaintiff to false arrest, false imprisonment, and deprivation of liberty without probable cause.
64. Plaintiff was conscious of his confinement.

65. Plaintiff did not consent to his confinement.
66. Plaintiff's arrest and false imprisonment was not otherwise privileged.
67. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
68. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.
69. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

70. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
71. The Defendants violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the U.S.
72. Constitution by wrongfully and illegally arresting, detaining and imprisoning Plaintiff.
73. The wrongful, unjustifiable, and unlawful apprehension, arrest, detention, and imprisonment of Plaintiff was carried out without a valid warrant, without Plaintiff's consent, and without probable cause or reasonable suspicion.
74. At all relevant times, Defendants acted forcibly in apprehending, arresting, and imprisoning Plaintiff.
75. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

76. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.
77. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene
New York State Law

78. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
79. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct and failed to intervene.
80. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
81. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene
Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

82. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
83. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct and failed to intervene.
84. Accordingly, the Defendants who failed to intervene violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments.

85. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Abuse of Process

Under New York State Law

86. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
87. Dependents arrested, detained and caused a criminal prosecution to be initiated against Plaintiff to compel the compliance or forbearance of some act.
88. Defendants had no excuse or justification to forcibly detain or initiate a prosecution against Plaintiff, especially with the absence of any cognizable probable cause.
89. Defendant intended to inflict substantial harm upon Plaintiff.
90. Defendant acted to achieve a collateral purpose, beyond or in addition to Plaintiff's criminal prosecution.
91. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
92. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Abuse of Process

Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

93. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
94. Dependents arrested, detained and caused a criminal prosecution to be initiated against Plaintiff to compel the compliance or forbearance of some act.
95. Defendants had no excuse or justification to forcibly detain or initiate a prosecution against Plaintiff, especially with the absence of any cognizable probable cause.

- 96. Defendant intended to inflict substantial harm upon Plaintiff.
- 97. Defendant acted to achieve a collateral purpose, beyond or in addition to Plaintiff's criminal prosecution.
- 98. Defendant's actions deprived plaintiff of his constitutional rights, under the Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution.
- 99. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention and Supervision
Under New York State Law

- 100. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
- 101. Defendant City owed a duty of care to Plaintiff to adequately hire, retain and supervise its employee defendants.
- 102. Defendant City breached that duty of care.
- 103. Defendant City placed defendants in a position where they could inflict foreseeable harm.
- 104. Defendant City knew or should have known of its employee Defendants' propensity for violating the individual rights granted under the United States Constitution and the laws of the State of New York, prior to the injuries incurred by Plaintiff.
- 105. Defendant City failed to take reasonable measures in hiring, retaining and supervising its employee Defendants that would have prevented the aforesaid injuries to Plaintiff.
- 106. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.
- 107. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Municipal "Monell" Liability

42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

108. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
109. Defendants, collectively and individually, while acting under color of state law, acquiesced in a pattern of unconstitutional conduct by subordinate police officers, and were directly responsible for the violation of the plaintiff's constitutional rights.
110. Defendant City maintained a policy or custom that caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his civil rights, tacitly approved of such violent conduct or was deliberately indifferent toward the potential exposure of individuals, such as Plaintiff, to such a violent behavior.
111. Defendant City's employee police officers have engaged in an illegal pattern and practice of misconduct, so consistent and widespread that it constitutes a custom or usage, of which a supervisor or policymaker must have been aware of them.
112. Defendant City, its policymakers and supervisors fail to provide adequate training or supervision to their subordinates, to such an extent that it is tantamount to the City's deliberate indifference towards the rights of those who may come into contact with defendant City's employees.
113. Defendant City's employees engaged in such a egregious and flagrant violations of Plaintiff's constitutional right that the need for enhanced training or supervision is obvious and equates to his display of indifference towards the rights of individuals, who may come into contact with infinite City's employees.
114. Defendant City's repeated refusal or failure to install or apply corrective or preventive measures constitutes the tacit approval of such violent behaviors or a deliberate indifference to the rights of those who may be affected by such behavior.

115. Defendant City's conduct cause the violation of Plaintiff civil rights enumerated within the Constitution of the United States pursuant to the Fourth, Sixth, and Fourteenth and under rights including:
- a) Not to be deprived of liberty without due process of law;
 - b) To be free from seizure and arrest not based upon probable cause;
 - c) To be free from excessive force;
 - d) Not to have summary punishment imposed upon him; and
 - e) To receive equal protection under the law.
116. As a direct and proximate result of this conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

JURY DEMAND

117. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests judgment against Defendants, jointly and severally, as follows:

- a) On the First Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- b) On the Second Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- c) On the Third Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- d) On the Fourth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;

- e) On the Fifth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- f) On the Sixth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- g) On the Seventh Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- h) On the Eighth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- i) On the Ninth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- j) On the Tenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- k) Awarding Plaintiff reasonable attorneys' fees and costs pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988;
- l) Together with the costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law.

Dated: New York, New York
October 4, 2020



DEVERNA LAW
By John Paul DeVerna, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff(s)
111 John Street, Suite 1615
New York, New York 10038
T- (212) 321-0025
F- (212) 321-0024

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

JOHN PAUL DEVERNA, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a counsel of the law firm of **DEVERNA LAW**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
October 4, 2020



DEVERNA LAW
By John Paul DeVerna, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff(s)
111 John Street, Suite 1615
New York, New York 10038
T- (212) 321-0025
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Index No. :

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NE W YORK

COUNTY OF BRONX

DEMETRUES BELL,

Plaintiff,

-against-

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JUAN CANDELARIO; POLICE OFFICER YAHKEEM WHITE; POLICE OFFICER
MICHAEL PANDO; AND SERGEANT MICHAEL BLETCHER,

Defendants.

SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT

DEVERNA LAW
By John Paul DeVerna, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff(s)
111 John Street, Suite 1615
New York, New York 10038

To: CORPORATION COUNSEL OF NEW YORK
Attorney(s)for Defendants

Service of a copy of the within is hereby admitted.

Dated

Attorney(s) for Plaintiff